

Appendix 4.6.2C. Department Chair/School Associate Dean Candidate Recommendation Form for Advancement and/or Tenure

CALDWELL UNIVERSITY Caldwell, New Jersey 07006

NAME Salvatore Ferraro

DEPARTMENT School of Business & Computer Science

Recommendation for Advancement ☒ Tenure ☐

Name of Candidate Vladislav D. Veksler

Department of Candidate Computer Science & Information Systems

Date of Initial Appointment Jan 2022

Present Rank Assistant Professor Date of Appointment to Present Rank Jan 2022

Rank Applied For Associate Professor To Become Effective Jan 2027

Rating of Candidate

QUANTITATIVE CRITERIA

I. Advanced Degrees Study Yes ☒ No ☐

Description:

II. Years of Successful College Teaching Experience and Related Professional Activity

Yes ☒ No ☐

Description:

Dr. Veksler holds a Masters and a Ph.D. from Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute.

Dr. Veksler has seventeen (17) years of College Teaching Experience and Related Professional Activity, including seven years of full-time teaching experience (two years at Rensselaer and five years at Caldwell University), two years of experience teaching part-time, and eleven years as a post-doctoral research fellow and a professional research scientist.

QUALITATIVE CRITERIA (full descriptions of each of these criteria can be found in section 4.5.1.1 of the Faculty Handbook)

	Outstanding	Very good	Good	Needs improvement	Unacceptable
Teaching Effectiveness (4.5.1.1.1)	X				
Academic Advising and Mentoring (4.5.1.1.2)	X				
Scholarship (4.5.1.1.3)	X				
Service (4.5.1.1.4)	X				
Collegiality (4.5.1.1.5)	X				

SOURCES OF INFORMATION: Candidate X Faculty X Students X

Application materials X Other _____

Specify

I have observed Dr. Veksler in the classroom, he is very engaging during his lectures and encourages students to participate. I have spoken to other faculty all have raved about his abilities. Students enjoy his classes and this shows with the number of students requesting research and working with him.

List any discrepancies noticed on the candidate's application:

Please write a letter of recommendation and provide specific evidence to support the Department's recommendation for or against the Application. Please reference the ratings provided above to support your evaluation for each of these criteria, especially clarifying extremes and apparent inconsistencies.

Dr. Vladislav Daniel Veksler is an exceptionally qualified candidate for promotion, demonstrating a profound commitment to academic excellence, leadership, and student success at Caldwell University. Holding the prestigious Alvin R. Calman Endowed Chair, Dr. Veksler serves the university in multiple critical leadership capacities, including as Director of both the C-STEM and CogAI Research Laboratories, and as the Co-director of the Center for Teaching and Learning. His multifaceted contributions span across exemplary teaching, robust institutional service, and an outstanding record of high-impact student mentorship.

Dr. Veksler exemplifies teaching excellence through a clear pedagogical vision that bridges foundational computer science principles with real-world, industry-standard execution. His core instructional philosophy centers on inspiring an enduring passion for problem-solving while providing an equitable, supportive, and career-ready environment for every student. He has demonstrated remarkable efficacy across the full spectrum of the computer science curriculum, instructing everything from 100-level foundational courses to advanced 400-level requirements. Notably, he led the substantial institutional effort to modernize the curriculum by transitioning the core programming sequence from Java to Python to align with modern industry expectations, and he authored standardized master course materials on Blackboard to preserve rigorous instructional consistency across the department.

As an educator, Dr. Veksler consistently achieves stellar student evaluations, maintaining an average overall rating of 4.9 out of 5.0, which has earned him five consecutive nominations for the Excellence in Teaching Award (2022–2026). A true innovator in classroom management, Dr. Veksler leverages his technical expertise to actively build custom software solutions when existing marketplace tools fall short. He independently developed proprietary, multi-factor academic applications—including *LectureSeats* for attendance tracking and *LectureTest* for secure, proctored coding exams—which protect academic integrity against generative AI and have since been adopted cross-departmentally by university faculty in both Business and Psychology. His innovative approach to pedagogy is matched by his extensive contributions to institutional growth; he has been a major contributor to proposals for the new MS in Computer Science and STEM MBA graduate programs, redesigned the Computer Science major, and single-handedly developed over a dozen new undergraduate and graduate courses.

Beyond the classroom, Dr. Veksler has established a vibrant culture of undergraduate research and competitive excellence. As the founder and director of the C-STEM and CogAI Research Laboratories, he has advised nearly 100 student projects. Under his direct advisory, funding acquisition, and laboratory support, Caldwell University students have achieved unprecedented success in prestigious intercollegiate coding competitions, capturing six 1st-place prizes (including HackPrinceton, HackNYU, and HopHacks) and securing a Top 10 finalist spot at HackMIT.

Since joining Caldwell University in 2022, Dr. Veksler has further demonstrated an exceptional commitment to student success through high-volume, holistic academic advising and mentorship. Managing a continuous annual roster of 40–50+ advisees across Computer Science, CIS, and Marketing, his approach goes far beyond routine course scheduling to actively integrate career readiness and internship placement. His deep investment in his students' long-term

professional milestones is highlighted by his extensive service in authoring approximately 150 to 200 tailored letters of recommendation, successfully placing students in competitive scholarships, summer research programs, fellowships, graduate schools, and industry careers. Dr. Veksler's rare combination of cutting-edge research expertise, pedagogical excellence, and unwavering dedication to the Caldwell University community makes him a premier asset to the institution and uniquely deserving of this promotion.

As Department Chair, it is a privilege to enthusiastically and unequivocally recommend Dr. Vladislav Veksler for promotion in the School of Business and Computer Science at Caldwell University. Since joining our faculty in 2022 and assuming the prestigious Alvin R. Calman Endowed Chair, Dr. Veksler has proven to be an indispensable leader, serving with distinction as Director of the C-STEM and CogAI Research Laboratories and Co-director of the Center for Teaching and Learning. He has spearheaded advancements within our department, developing over a dozen graduate and undergraduate courses and modernizing our core curriculum by transitioning it to Python. Dr. Veksler pairs this immense administrative output with unparalleled classroom excellence, maintaining a 4.9 out of 5.0 average student evaluation rating and earning five consecutive nominations for the Excellence in Teaching Award. Beyond the classroom, his commitment to student success is unmatched; he has supervised nearly 100 student research projects, championed a continuous roster of 40–50+ advisees, and coached our students to six 1st-place victories at elite intercollegiate hacking competitions including HackPrinceton and HackNYU. Dr. Veksler represents the absolute highest standard of faculty excellence, and he has my highest endorsement for this well-deserved promotion.